

Shared History



Print this and keep it beside your character sheet

Your five characters have grown up together in the village of **Amble**. You are eight years old, and you have known each other your entire lives — your families know each other, your parents drink at the same tavern. The three memories below are canon for the whole party. You're welcome to add smaller ones of your own in play, but these are the foundation of your friendship.

SUMMER — The Great Raft Disaster

Ages 7, nearly 8

The five of you built a raft on the stream north of the village. Old Marn — the retired scout who lives on the south road, the one your parents trust — told you it wouldn't hold. You didn't listen. It held for exactly three minutes, then came apart in the current, dumping all of you into the water in front of the entire village's washing party. Mother Yela was there. Kess the Weaver was there. Your parents were told before you got home. Old Marn didn't say "*I told you so*" once, which was somehow worse.

AUTUMN — The Night at the Shrine

Age 7

Bram Cotter — a boy from the east side of Amble, a couple of years older than you, and terrible — said the old shrine at the woodline was haunted by a boy who died in the plague fifty years ago. The five of you snuck out one moonless night to prove him wrong. You spent an hour in the dark, terrified, hearing every branch snap as a footstep. Nothing haunted the shrine. But Ser Aldric, the shrine's priest, caught you on the way home and made you help repair the shrine wall the next morning. He never told your parents.

WINTER — The Cubby's First Beam

The winter before Session One, nearly 8

Late in the winter, on a cold clear day, the five of you dragged a fallen branch from the woodline to the old oak on the south side of the village — the great tree everyone calls the Council Tree — and hoisted it up as the first proper beam of the cubby. It took all afternoon. Old Marn found you halfway through and pretended not to notice what you were doing. Mother Yela brought hot cider to the tree at dusk without being asked. That's when the cubby stopped being a pile of scraps and started being a place. It's still holding up. You've been building it ever since.

What these memories tell you

- **You are close.** You've kept each other's secrets for years, and you know each other's tells.
- **You are brave and a bit foolish** — you build rafts that don't float, sneak into haunted places, and get away with it.
- **Adults look out for you.** Old Marn, Mother Yela, Ser Aldric — all quietly on your side.
- **Amble has room for kids like you.** The village isn't perfect, but it's home.
- **You already have a place.** The cubby at the Council Tree is yours alone.

Add anything else you like about your shared history — the DM will bring it into play.